

BWS44004: IT Professional Practice and Ethics

Synopsis:

This course discusses how these modern systems evolved over time and how the digitisation of data has changed science and business through the use of technologies aimed at supporting decision making. The course will look at the ethical implications of the widespread use of these systems and how governance frameworks are used to guide businesses in the ethical use of ICT.

At the end of this course, the students will be able to:

CLO1: Demonstrate and communicate a conceptual understanding of the implications of digital innovation within a business case study. (C4; LOD9; PLO6)

CLO2: Communicate a clear, coherent and independent analysis of the use of data analysis tools, Decision support Systems and IT governance and IT standards and frameworks in Business. (P4; LOD14; PLO10)

CLO3: Apply normative competency to understand and convey ethical implications in ICT artefact development. (A4; LOD16; PLO11, SC8)

Content Outline of the Course:

TOPIC 1: Digital Innovation and Disruption

Guidelines: Students will learn the fundamental concepts of ICT and digital transformation. They will explore historical and modern examples of digital disruption, understand how innovation reshapes industries, and evaluate its impact on organizations, customer behavior, and society.

TOPIC 2: Decision Support Systems and Analytics

Guidelines: Students will learn the concepts and applications of Decision Support Systems (DSS). They will differentiate between traditional and modern DSS approaches, including real-time analytics, and assess the effective use and potential misuse of DSS in business decision-making.

TOPIC 3: Governance, Audit, and Regulation of ICT

Guidelines: Students will learn the principles of ICT governance, audit, and regulation. They will understand the legal, ethical, and compliance requirements of cyberspace, explore governance frameworks, and evaluate practitioner insights into ensuring accountability and transparency.

TOPIC 4: Ethics, Professional Responsibility, and Society

Guidelines: Students will learn ethical analysis frameworks and professional codes of conduct in ICT. They will examine issues of system reliability, cybersecurity, and data protection, and analyze the wider societal impact of technology on trust, responsibility, and professional practice.

TOPIC 5: Management, Communication, and Team Dynamics

Guidelines: Students will learn essential management concepts and professional communication skills. They will apply teamwork and leadership principles, develop effective collaboration strategies, and reflect on current ICT trends to prepare for real-world workplace dynamics.

Materials to deliver the course: Lecture slides, case studies on ethical dilemmas in ICT, professional codes of ethics, company ICT governance policies, cybersecurity regulations, audit reports, practitioner interviews, and industry standards documentation.

Expected outcomes: Students will understand the foundations of professional ethics in ICT, critically analyze ethical, legal, and social issues in technology, and apply professional codes of conduct in workplace scenarios. They will be able to evaluate governance frameworks, ensure compliance with ICT regulations, and make ethically sound decisions in real-world professional practice. Students will also develop effective communication and teamwork skills necessary for ethical ICT management and decision-making.

Method of assessment: WBL Logbook / Case Study Analysis / Practical Demonstration / Online Quiz / Observation

Assessment:

PLO6: Digital Skills, **PLO10:** Entrepreneurial Skill, **PLO11:** Ethics and Professional, **SC8:** Normative Competency

Assessment	Assessor	CLO	PLO	Level	Assessment Tool	%
Continuous	University	CLO1	PLO6	C4	Online Quiz	10
		CLO1	PLO6	C4	(WBL Progress Logbook Report)	10
		CLO3	PLO11	A4-SC8	Video Presentation	10
	Industry	CLO1	PLO6	C4	(WBL Progress Logbook Report)	20
		CLO3	PLO11	A4-SC8	Observation	20
		CLO2	PLO10	P4	Demonstration	30
	Total					100

